SPIRITUAL/RELIGIOUS FALSE BELIEF #97 · MARRIAGE, SEX & FAMILY

“Because I am divorced, God can’t use me.”

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Where it often comes from

Church policies that kept divorced people from serving. Shame or judgment from other Christians. Grief over a marriage that ended, whether or not it was your choice. Verses about divorce used without grace. Feeling like a failure or second-class Christian.

What Scripture teaches

God takes marriage seriously, and divorce is painful. But divorce is not beyond God’s grace or His purposes. God says, “Behold, I am about to do something new.” Jesus spoke with a Samaritan woman who had been married five times, and many in her town believed because of her testimony. God promises to repay the years the locusts have eaten, and to work all things together for good for those who love Him. Your story is not over.

> *“‘Do not call to mind the former things; pay no attention to the things of old. Behold, I am about to do something new; even now it is coming. Do you not see it? Indeed, I will make a way in the wilderness and streams in the desert.’”* **(Isaiah 43:18–19)**.

Also see

> “Many of the Samaritans from that town believed in Jesus because of the woman’s testimony, ‘He told me everything I ever did.’” **(John 4:39)**.

> “I will repay you for the years eaten by locusts— the swarming locust, the young locust, the destroying locust, and the devouring locust— My great army that I sent against you” **(Joel 2:25)**.

> “And we know that God works all things together for the good of those who love Him, who are called according to His purpose” **(Romans 8:28)**.

> “Therefore if anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation. The old has passed away. Behold, the new has come!” **(2 Corinthians 5:17)**.

Common self-statements

- I’m damaged goods.
- God can’t use someone who failed at marriage.
- I’m a second-class Christian now.
- My divorce disqualifies me forever.
- I have nothing to offer God.
- Everyone at church sees me as a failure.

Common logical errors

- **Labeling:** Defining yourself by one painful event.
- **Overgeneralization:** Turning “my marriage ended” into “my usefulness to God ended.”
- **Mind reading:** Assuming everyone sees you as a failure.

- **Discounting God's grace:** Overlooking God's pattern of using broken people.

Challenging questions

- Whom did Jesus use to reach a whole town in John 4?
- What does God say He is about to do in Isaiah 43:19?
- Does God work only through people with perfect histories?
- What has God taught me through this pain that could help others?
- Have I brought any part of this I need to confess to God?
- Is the judgment I fear coming from God or from people?
- How might God want to use me now?

Truth summary

> My divorce does not disqualify me from being used by God. He is doing something new in my life. God used a woman with a broken history to bring a whole town to Jesus, and He can use me. He can restore what was lost and work even this together for good.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Divorce
- Grace
- Hopeless
- Forgiveness
- Self-Esteem, Low

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Divorce
- Forgive/Forgiveness
- Self-Esteem, Low

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> **Overcoming Depression** · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Because I am divorced, God can't use me"

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Read through each section and **check the one that fits you best**. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ **Date started:** _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Because I am divorced, God can't use me." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Whom did Jesus use to reach a town?
- ☐ What is God about to do?
- ☐ Does God use only perfect people?
- ☐ What has this pain taught me that could help others?
- ☐ Is the judgment I fear from God or people?
- ☐ How might God use me now?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ My divorce does not disqualify me.
- ☐ God is doing something new in my life.
- ☐ God uses people with broken stories.
- ☐ God can restore the years that were lost.
- ☐ God works all things together for good.
- ☐ In Christ I am a new creation.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- [ ] **Isaiah 43:18–19**
  "'Do not call to mind the former things; pay no attention to the things of old. Behold, I am about to do something new; even now it is coming. Do you not see it? Indeed, I will make a way in the wilderness and streams in the desert.'"
- [ ] **John 4:39**
  "Many of the Samaritans from that town believed in Jesus because of the woman's testimony, 'He told me everything I ever did.'"
- [ ] **Joel 2:25**
  "I will repay you for the years eaten by locusts— the swarming locust, the young locust, the destroying locust, and the devouring locust— My great army that I sent against you."
- [ ] **Romans 8:28**
  "And we know that God works all things together for the good of those who love Him, who are called according to His purpose."
- [ ] **2 Corinthians 5:17**
  "Therefore if anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation. The old has passed away. Behold, the new has come!"

A verse I found myself: _____

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first three. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ **Make my Truth Card** (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ **Memorize my Scripture** from Step 4.
- ☐ **Set reminders** to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ **A buzz:** my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ **An everyday event:** every time I _____
  - ☐ **A visual reminder:** something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ **New things log:** Each day, write one new thing God is doing in my life or one way He used me.
- ☐ **My name in Scripture:** Rewrite my verse with my name in it and read it aloud each morning.
  *For example, Isaiah 43:19 becomes: "Behold, I am about to do something new in **Sarah's** life; even now it is coming. Does **she** not see it? Indeed, I will make a way in the wilderness and streams in the desert."*
- ☐ **Gratitude journal:** Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ **Truth recording:** Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ **Reading:** The "Divorce" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ **Listening:** The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

- ☐ **Read John 4:1–42,** and write how Jesus treated the woman and what happened afterward.
- ☐ **Serve in one small way this week,** and notice how God uses you.
- ☐ **Write your story honestly,** including where you have seen God's grace.
- ☐ **Talk with a pastor about serving,** and ask about divorce recovery support.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Because I am divorced, God can't use me": _____ % **My truth:** _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	One way God used me
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Because I am divorced, God can't use me.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, thank You that my divorce is not the end of my story. Help me reject the lie that You can't use me. Heal my heart, forgive what needs forgiving, and do something new in my life. Use my story to bring hope to others. In Jesus' name, Amen.

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Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.